

POL-OPS-006 - Account Suspension and Risk Action Policy

Policy | Operations

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RESTRICTED. This policy states the thresholds and logic used to suspend seller accounts. Disclosure would allow the controls to be circumvented. Readable only at RESTRICTED clearance. Seller-facing communication about a suspension must follow section 8 and must not reproduce section 5.

1. Purpose

This policy governs the suspension of seller accounts, the automated risk rules that trigger suspension, the review process, and the conditions for reinstatement.

Its governing principle: suspension exists to protect customers from harm arising from seller conduct. It is not a mechanism for recovering platform costs, and it must not penalise a seller for the consequences of a platform defect.

2. Scope

Applies to all seller accounts and to all risk actions, including full suspension, partial listing suspension, settlement hold and reserve increase.

Does not cover commercial tier changes, contract termination, or actions arising from a legal or regulatory order.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Risk action	Any automated or manual restriction applied to an account
Full suspension	All listings made unbuyable
Partial suspension	A defined subset of listings made unbuyable
Settlement hold	Payout withheld pending review
Trigger condition	A measured threshold that initiates a risk action
Trailing window	The measurement period over which a metric is evaluated
Platform-caused	A condition materially attributable to a platform defect or decision
Manual review gate	A requirement for human authorisation before an automated action

4. Principles

- P-1. Suspension protects customers. It is not a collection mechanism.
- P-2. A seller must not be penalised for the consequences of a platform defect.
- P-3. Speed matters for genuine conduct issues. Automated suspension remains available and this policy does not remove it.
- P-4. A metric must reflect the current state of the account, not only its history.
- P-5. Every automated action must be reviewable by a human, and the review must be able to reach a different conclusion.

5. Trigger Conditions

R-1. A single breached condition raises a **review flag**. Two or more simultaneously breached conditions initiate **automatic suspension**, subject to R-6 and R-7.

ID	Condition	Threshold	Trailing window
T-1	Return rate	Above 25 percent	30 days, trend-adjusted
T-2	Settlement chargeback ratio	Above 1.5 percent	30 days, trend-adjusted
T-3	Order defect rate	Above 8 percent	30 days
T-4	Confirmed counterfeit reports	1 or more	90 days
T-5	Undispatched order rate	Above 12 percent	14 days
T-6	Verified customer safety complaint	1 or more	Immediate

R-2. T-4 and T-6 initiate immediate suspension on a single breach. These are conduct and safety conditions where speed outweighs the cost of a false positive.

R-3. Thresholds are category-specific where category norms differ materially. The figures above are the fashion and footwear category baselines.

5.1 Trend Adjustment

R-4. Conditions T-1 and T-2 are evaluated with a trend component. A metric whose weekly value has declined for three or more consecutive weeks, and whose most recent weekly value is below the threshold, does not breach even where the trailing 30-day average exceeds the threshold.

R-5. Trend adjustment was added in version 3.0. Previously these conditions were evaluated on a trailing 30-day average alone, which allowed a suspension to be triggered by a condition that had already been resolved.

In September 2026 a footwear account was suspended on a trailing return rate of 26.4 percent at a point when its most recent weekly rate was 13 percent and had fallen for four consecutive weeks. The underlying cause, a platform size chart defect, had been fixed three weeks earlier. The rule was measuring a problem that no longer existed.

5.2 Platform Defect Exclusion

R-6. Where an open or recently closed platform defect is recorded and linked to an account, and is causally related to a trigger condition, the volume attributable to that defect is excluded from the metric.

R-7. Where such a linkage exists and the exclusion cannot be computed reliably, automatic suspension is **blocked** and a manual review gate applies.

R-8. Engineering must link a defect to affected accounts when the defect is recorded. This linkage is the input to R-6 and R-7 and is a required field on any incident with identified seller impact.

6. Risk Action Selection

R-9. The least restrictive action sufficient to stop customer harm is selected.

Situation	Action
Harm confined to identifiable listings	Partial suspension of those listings
Harm arising from fulfilment capability	Undispatched order restriction
Financial exposure without customer harm	Settlement hold or reserve increase
Harm across the catalogue, or conduct or safety condition	Full suspension

R-10. Full suspension of a dropship account stops all revenue immediately, because such an account has no alternative channel within the platform. This is considered when selecting the action.

7. Review

R-11. Every suspension is reviewed by Operations. Review begins within **4 working hours** of the action for an automated suspension.

R-12. The review must establish, in order:

1. Whether the trigger conditions were correctly measured.
2. Whether the underlying metric reflects the account's current state.
3. Whether a platform defect is causally related to the metric.
4. Whether there is evidence of seller conduct causing customer harm.
5. Whether a less restrictive action would be sufficient.

R-13. The review must examine the metric as a **trend**, not only as the trailing value the rule evaluated.

R-14. The review must check for a linked platform defect even where no linkage was recorded, because an unrecorded linkage is a known failure mode.

R-15. Where the review finds no evidence of seller conduct causing customer harm, the presumption is reinstatement.

8. Seller Communication

R-16. A suspension notice must state: which condition was breached, the threshold, the measurement window, the observed value, a named contact, and the review timeframe.

R-17. A notice stating only that an account is suspended pending review does not satisfy R-16 and is a policy breach.

R-18. The notice must not reproduce section 5 of this policy. It states the condition applicable to that account, not the full threshold set.

R-19. The named contact must be reachable during business hours on the day the notice is issued.

9. Reinstatement

R-20. Reinstatement is authorised by Operations, with IT executing the platform action.

R-21. Where a suspension is found to be platform-caused:

1. The event is recorded as **platform-caused** in the account risk history.
2. It is excluded from future risk assessment for that account.
3. Commercial consequences arising from the suspension are waived, including reserve adjustments and consequential costs.
4. A corrective action plan addresses the underlying defect and the rule that triggered incorrectly.

R-22. Where a suspension is upheld, a corrective action plan with measurable exit criteria is agreed before reinstatement.

R-23. A manual review gate remains in force for an account where a rule is known to have triggered incorrectly, until the rule is corrected and validated.

10. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Operations	Policy ownership, review, reinstatement decisions, rule calibration
IT	Execution of platform actions, access to risk tooling
Business	Commercial consequences, seller relationship, remedy decisions
Engineering	Defect-to-account linkage, metric correctness
Support	Seller communication and evidence gathering

11. Exceptions

E-1. A suspension may be lifted before review completes where continued suspension causes disproportionate harm and initial findings indicate a platform cause. The review is still completed.

E-2. A manual review gate may be applied to an account at Operations discretion, independent of any specific rule failure.

E-3. No exception may waive R-16 (notice content), R-11 (review timeframe) or R-21 (treatment of platform-caused suspensions).

12. Escalation

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
Automated suspension applied	Operations and Business	30 minutes
Review cannot begin within 4 working hours	Operations lead	On breach
Platform defect linkage suspected but not recorded	Engineering	Immediately
Seller disputes a review outcome	Business	1 working day
Rule triggered incorrectly	Operations lead; apply manual review gate	Immediately

13. Enforcement

Risk rules are implemented in the rules engine with the thresholds, windows and trend adjustments in section 5. A rule change requires approval by the policy owner.

Defect-to-account linkage is a required field on incident records with identified seller impact.

Suspension notices are generated from a template that enforces R-16. Every suspension review outcome is recorded with its reasoning.

Rule calibration is reviewed after any incorrect trigger and at least annually.

14. Review History

Version	Date	Change	Owner
1.0	2023-05-09	Initial suspension policy	Operations
2.0	2024-10-22	Automated triggers; two-condition rule introduced	Operations
2.1	2025-08-05	Category-specific thresholds	Neha Gupta
3.0	2026-10-16	Trend adjustment, platform defect exclusion, notice content requirements	Neha Gupta

Next scheduled review: April 2027.